Safeguarding Policy

Buzzy Bees Physiotherapy

Effective Date: 18/02/2026

Review Date: 18/02/2027

1. Policy Statement

Buzzy Bees Physiotherapy is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of children, young people, and adults at risk.

We recognise our duty of care to protect individuals from abuse, neglect, exploitation, and harm in all settings where we deliver services, including:

- Client homes
- Clinics
- Schools
- Community venues
- Hydrotherapy pools
- Outdoor rehabilitation settings

Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility. All staff, contractors, and associates must understand their role in recognising and responding to safeguarding concerns.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Physiotherapists
- Rehabilitation Assistants
- Administrative staff
- Students
- Contractors
- Volunteers

It covers both children (under 18) and adults at risk (as defined by the Care Act 2014).

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3. Definitions

Child

Any person under the age of 18.

Adult at Risk

An adult who:

- Has care and support needs
- Is experiencing, or at risk of, abuse or neglect
- Is unable to protect themselves because of those needs

4. Types of Abuse

Safeguarding concerns may include (but are not limited to):

Children and Adults

- Physical abuse
- Emotional or psychological abuse
- Sexual abuse
- Neglect or acts of omission
- Financial or material abuse
- Discriminatory abuse
- Domestic abuse
- Modern slavery
- Exploitation (including criminal or sexual exploitation)
- Online abuse

Staff must remain vigilant to signs including unexplained injuries, behavioural changes, withdrawal, fearfulness, or disclosure.

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5. Safer Recruitment

We are committed to safer recruitment practices, including:

- Enhanced DBS checks where appropriate
- Verification of identity and qualifications
- Professional registration checks (HCPC)
- References prior to employment
- Ongoing professional supervision

6. Responsibilities

Safeguarding Lead

The Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL) is:

Name: Claire Williamson

Role: Director

Contact: info@buzzybeesphysio.co.uk

The DSL is responsible for:

- Receiving safeguarding concerns
- Making referrals to local authority safeguarding teams
- Liaising with schools, social care, or police where required
- Maintaining safeguarding records
- Ensuring staff training compliance

If the DSL is unavailable and there is immediate risk, staff must contact emergency services (999) or the relevant local authority safeguarding team directly.

7. Recognising and Responding to Concerns

If a child or adult discloses abuse:

- Stay calm
- Listen carefully
- Do not promise confidentiality

- Reassure them they have done the right thing
- Do not investigate
- Record facts accurately and objectively

If you observe signs of harm:

- Document factual observations
- Report immediately to the DSL

If someone is in immediate danger:

- Call 999
- Inform the DSL as soon as possible

8. Reporting Procedure

1. Immediate risk → Contact emergency services.
2. Report concern to Designated Safeguarding Lead (Claire Williamson).
3. DSL assesses and refers to:
    - Local Authority Children's Services
    - Adult Safeguarding Team
    - Police (if criminal offence suspected)

All concerns must be recorded within 24 hours.

9. Working in Community Settings

When working in homes, schools, or community venues:

- Lone working risk assessments must be completed
- Staff must follow professional boundaries
- Visits must be documented
- Any environmental concerns (e.g., unsafe living conditions) must be reported

If staff feel unsafe, they should withdraw and inform management immediately.

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10. Professional Boundaries

Staff (including subcontractors) must:

- Maintain clear professional boundaries
- Avoid dual relationships
- Not accept significant gifts
- Not engage in personal social media contact with clients

Any concerns about boundary issues must be reported.

11. Information Sharing

Information will be shared on a 'need to know' basis in accordance with:

- UK GDPR
- Data Protection Act 2018

Safeguarding concerns override confidentiality where there is risk of harm.

Consent will be sought where appropriate, but it is not required where there is risk of serious harm.

12. Training

All staff must:

- Complete safeguarding training appropriate to their role
- Undertake refresher training at least every 2–3 years
- Receive safeguarding induction

The DSL should undertake enhanced safeguarding training.

13. Record Keeping

Safeguarding records will be:

- Factual and objective
- Dated and signed
- Stored securely
- Kept separate from general clinical notes where appropriate

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14. Whistleblowing

Staff who are concerned about unsafe practice or organisational failings may raise concerns internally with the DSL or management.

If concerns are not addressed, staff may escalate to:

- Local Authority Safeguarding Team
- HCPC
- NSPCC Whistleblowing Helpline

Staff will not suffer detriment for raising genuine concerns.

15. Review

This policy will be reviewed annually or sooner if legislation or guidance changes.

Emergency Contact Section

Children's Safeguarding Team:

Derbyshire: 01629 533190 (Mon-Fri, 8 am-6 pm) or 01629 532600 (out of hours)

Nottinghamshire: 0300 500 80 90 (Mon-Thu 8:30am-5pm, Fri 8:30am-4:30pm) or submit an online referral or 0300 456 4546 (out of hours)

Staffordshire: 0300 111 8007 (Mon-Thu 8:30am-5pm, Fri 8:30am-4:30pm) or 0345 604 2886 (out of hours)

Adult Safeguarding Team:

Derbyshire: 01629 533190 available 24/7

Nottinghamshire: County 0300 500 80 90 (or 0300 500 80 80) or Nottingham City 0115 8763330

Staffordshire: 0345 604 2719 - (Monday to Friday 9am to 5pm) or 0345 604 2886 (out of hours)

Police (non-emergency): 101

Emergency: 999